



INTRAVENOUS LINES / ARTERIAL LINES / IV DRUG LINES / ORAL LIQUID DRUGS

All intravenous and arterial lines, nasogastric tubes, urinary catheters, ventilation equipment should be managed / changed according to NCCU / UCLH / manufacturer guidelines

Remember products available in NCCU can change so always check manufacturer's guidelines

STANDARD

Lines / catheters appropriately labelled (date / time), discussed daily on NCCU ward round, removed when no longer required.

Lines inspected each shift, documented in EPIC, dressing changed as required - immediately change if wet / dirty / loose, otherwise change by date stipulated below. Escalate Visual Infusion Phlebitis (VIP) Score >1.

Standard Aseptic Non-Touch Technique (ANTT®) when dealing with all lines / catheters. Needle free connectors decontaminated before use (ANTT® Policy) with 2% chlorhexidine gluconate in 70% isopropyl alcohol (Clinell® wipe), Hub scrubbed for 15 seconds and allowed to dry. Consider aqueous chlorhexidine gluconate if manufacturer's recommendation prohibits use of alcohol with their device.

IMPORTED LINES

1. **PERIPHERAL LINE:** change on admission / within 24h
2. **CENTRAL LINE:** change within 24h unless documented evidence of insertion using ANTT or contraindications to change (*abnormal clotting*)
3. **ARTERIAL LINE:** change within 24h unless documented evidence of insertion using ANTT or contraindications to change (*abnormal clotting*)

PERIPHERAL LINES

1. **PERIPHERAL CANNULA:** re-site when clinically indicated and not routinely
2. **DRESSING:** Tegaderm transparent dressing – change after 7 days



CENTRAL VENOUS LINES

1. **CENTRAL VENOUS CATHETER:** Should not be routinely replaced. Remove when no longer needed
2. **DRESSING:** Tegaderm CHG™ plus Statlock® - change every 7 days
3. **TRANSDUCER SET:** Lines, transducers, fluids - change every 96h
4. **NEEDLE-FREE CONNECTOR:** change with each new transducer set



GIVING SETS / DRUG LINES

1. **GIVING SET:**
 - Solution sets (Infusomat Space Line / Perfusor Line) – change after 72h
 - Solution sets and blood sets are **not** interchangeable
 - Blood & blood products
 - Blood sets in continuous use: change every 12h and discard when transfusion(s) complete
 - Platelets: via **platelet infusion set**, discard when transfusion(s) complete
2. **DRUG LINES** - Change after 48h, with exception of:
 - **Propofol** – change after 12h
 - **Insulin** – change after 24h
 - **Phenytoin** – discard after each administration

N.B. Propofol & Neuromuscular Blocking Agents (NMBAs) not compatible in same line
3. **NEEDLE-FREE CONNECTOR:** change every 7 days

ARTERIAL LINES

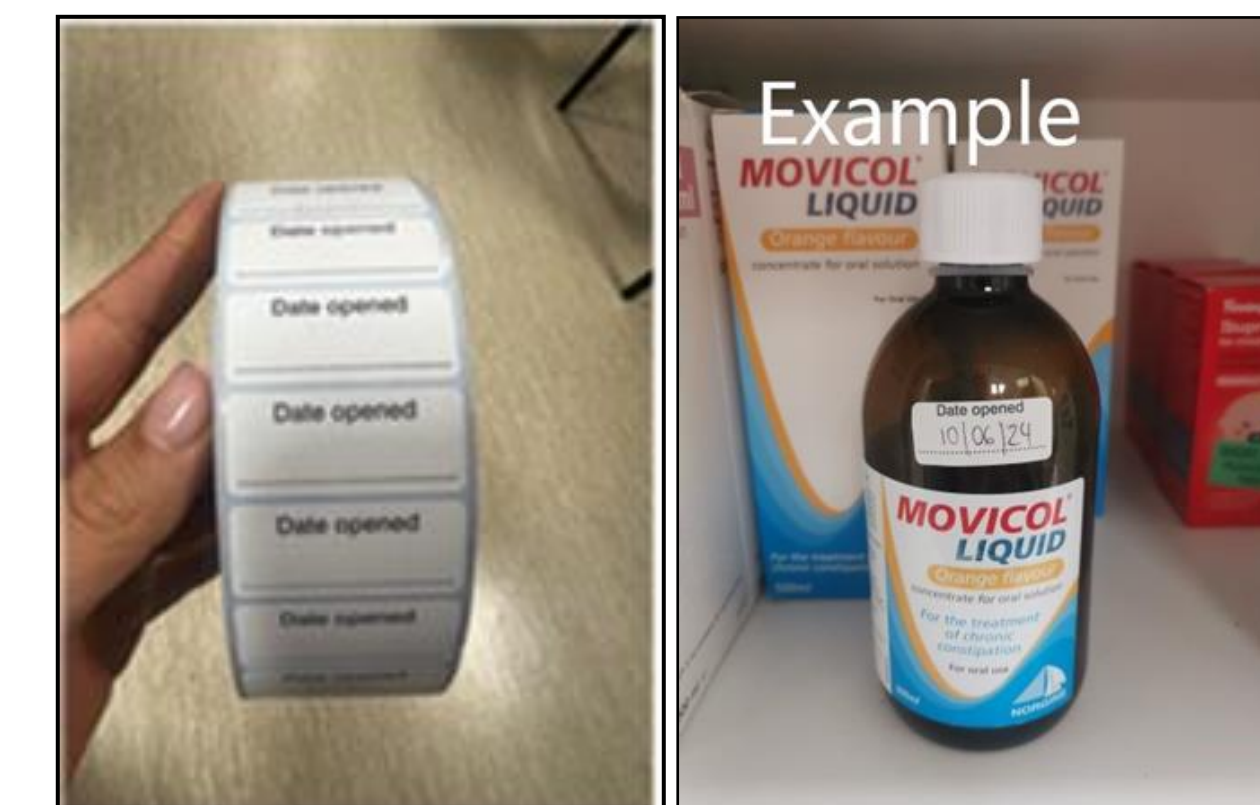
1. **ARTERIAL CATHETER:** Do not routinely replace (infection risk much lower than venous access devices) – daily inspection of site, document in EPIC, escalate VIP score >1
2. **DRESSING:** STATLOCK Sutureless + Transparent dressing with slow-release 2% chlorhexidine gel) – change every 7 days
3. **TRANSDUCER SET:** Lines, transducers, fluids - change every 96h
4. **NEEDLE-FREE CONNECTOR:** change with each new transducer set

ORAL LIQUID DRUGS

UCLH policy - expiry date for oral liquid medicines is 56 days (8 weeks) from first opening date, unless the manufacturer advises shorter expiry date (*please refer to product packaging*)

For example, metformin liquid in current supply has short expiry of 28 days after opening and must be stored in the fridge

PLEASE APPLY A LABEL WHEN OPENING A NEW BOTTLE OF LIQUID DRUGS



Opened bottles without a clearly marked opening date will need to be disposed of for safety reasons

Applying a label will ensure patient safety and help to reduce wastage of medicines, as oral liquid medicines are usually expensive

MULTI - DOSE VIALS

1. Once a multi-dose vial has been opened or accessed (e.g. needle-punctured) the vial should be dated with the last date that the product should be used (expiration date)
2. Discard within **28 days** unless the manufacturer specifies a different (*shorter or longer*) date



VENTILATION EQUIPMENT / ENTERAL FEEDING / URINARY CATHETERS / MISCELLANEOUS

All intravenous and arterial lines, nasogastric tubes, urinary catheters, ventilation equipment should be managed / changed according to NCCU / UCLH / manufacturer guidelines

Remember products available in NCCU can change so always check manufacturer's guidelines

STANDARD

All disposable equipment appropriately labelled (date / time). All devices checked each shift, documented in EPIC, changed as required (*wet, dirty / loose dressings or where integrity of device has been compromised, change immediately*), otherwise change by the dates stipulated below.

ENDOTRACHEAL TUBE (ETT)

1. **PORTEX™ SACETT™ Endotracheal Tube** allows suctioning secretions from subglottic space (above cuff) – ETT change directed by NCCU consultant
2. **MANOMETER CUFF PRESSURE** - check once every shift (range: 22-32cm H₂O)
3. **ANCHORFAST Guard Oral ET Tube Fastener** – change every 3-5 days (*to reduce risk of lip abrasions, change position of ETT if safe to do so at least once per shift*)
4. **COW HITCH TIE / BLUE TIE** – change every 12-24h
5. **TRACHSEAL CLOSED SUCTION SYSTEM** – change every 24-72h
 - Available for 24h or 72h usage
 - 2 length options for either endotracheal (54cm) or tracheostomy (30cm) tube

TRACHEOSTOMY TUBE

1. **PORTEX Blue Line Ultra SuctionAid** – change every 29 days (1st elective change >7 days)
 - Manometer cuff pressure check once every shift (range: 22-32cm H₂O)
 - Remove and clean inner tube every 4h
 - Inner cannula reusable (but single patient use) - should be replaced with new inner tube if any signs of wear and tear
 - **Flange sutures** remove 5-7 days (*check patient specific documentation*)
 - **Rescue sutures** remove 24h post decannulation
2. **TRACHEOSTOMY TIES / KEYHOLE DRESSING** - change every 24h
3. **TRACHSEAL™ CLOSED SUCTION SYSTEM** - change every 24-72h
 - Available for 24h or 72h usage
 - 2 length options for either endotracheal (54cm) or tracheostomy (30cm) tube

VENTILATOR TUBING

1. **WET / DRY CIRCUIT** – change every 14 days
2. **AIRVO 2** – change every 14 days
3. **AEROGEN SOLO (NEBULISER)**
 - **Intermittent use** change with each new ventilator circuit
 - **Continuous use** change every 7 days
4. **TRANSPORT VENTILATOR** - Reusable, patient specific tubing (*label and keep at patient bedside after use*)

VENTILATOR FILTERS

1. **BACTERIAL FILTER** (ventilator end) – change every 12h if patient ventilation allows
2. **HME FILTER** (used with dry circuit) - change every 24h (*if nebuliser required, remember to insert nebuliser on patient side of filter*)

NASOPHARYNGEAL AIRWAY (NPA)

1. **SINGLE** patient use – *can be cleaned and reinserted*
2. **DURATION** of use - *no consensus on recommended duration that NPA can remain in situ*
 - Consider risks of repeated insertion vs in situ for several days
 - Daily review of continued need for NPA

URINARY CATHETER

1. **INDWELLING URINARY CATHETER**
 - **Imported catheter**
 - Not long-term catheter, change at 30 days
 - No evidence of insertion date, change within 24h
 - **Long-term catheter**: change at 12 weeks
2. **CATHETER BAG** – change every 7 days (*label change date*)

ENTERAL FEEDING TUBE (NGT)

1. **IMPORTED LARGE BORE NGT** - change to fine bore within 48h of admission / prior to discharge to ward
2. **FINE BORE NGT** - can remain in situ for 90 days / 3 months (*in practice can remain in situ for as long as NGT maintains its integrity and is fully functional*)
3. **ENTERAL FEEDING SET / BAG**: change every 24h
4. **NGT TAPE** – change every 24h

EXTERNAL VENTRICULAR DRAIN (EVD)

1. **See specific protocol for EVDs**
2. **DRAINAGE BAG**:
 - **Gravity drain**: change only when full, using ANTT
 - **LiquoGuard**: empty when full

MISCELLANEOUS

SEDLINE Brain Function Monitoring (MASSIMO) – change sensors every 5 days

ARCTIC SUN TTM System - ArcticGel Pads replace every 5 days / replace as needed if loss of integrity or adhesion

DIGNISHIELD Stool Management System (Dignicare) – uninterrupted use maximum 29 days (this includes immediate replacement with same or identical device)

PRISMAFLEX Continuous Renal Replacement Therapy (CRRT) - change every 72h (*unless plan to cease CRRT or have filter 'holiday' within following 24h*)